where Siya's father has a store. A relative of the Goyals claims Sahil had at some point confronted the two about their relationship, but they denied it, with Siya even offering to tie a rakhi on Chetan.

The police are now trying to piece together the details that are coming out to establish the connection between the two. Siya is said to have asked Ketan's uncle around a month-and-a-half ago if the marriage could be postponed for a year. A purported screenshot of a May 25 Snapchat conversation is being examined: it has Siya asking a friend to send her Aadhaar card so that flight tickets could be booked for the wedding "which was never going to happen" . The police also say Siya and Chetan exchanged 2,004 phone calls between January and June.

On June 6, Ketan and sister Sanjana, along with Siya and brother Sahil, were scheduled to fly to Bali for a pre-wedding shoot. But, at the Mumbai airport, Ketan's passport was found missing from his bag (Siya is now suspected of disposing of it too). This had led to some tensions and, in his statement to the police, Ketan's father Vishal alleged that post their return, his son told him that Siya and he often argued over minor issues.

THE LURE OF LOHAGAD

Siya and Ketan visited Lohagad together on May 31, where the idea for the murder is said to have first occurred to her. She allegedly wanted the two of them to visit the fort again on June 4, but Ketan's mother shot down the plan. They did, eventually, go to the fort again on June 14 when, according to the police, Siya made an attempt on Ketan's life by pushing him near a precipice. Ketan apparently saved himself by holding on to a tree. Siya had then claimed that she acted to save him from a snake. A police investigator says they asked Ketan's mother and sister why he revisited the fort on June 14 and 18. "Ketan told them that after her request on June 4 was turned down, Siya had cried and thrown a tantrum. He told his family that since Siya was celebrating her 20th birthday on June 19 in Mahabaleshwar, her friends had decided to surprise her with an excursion to Lohagad the previous day," says the officer.

Meanwhile, the police say Siya and Chetan met in a coffee shop at Lullanagar on June 17, where they allegedly searched for videos of the fort, downloaded maps of Lohagad from Google Earth, and used AI tools to decide the modus operandi and select a secluded location. The two apparently also used a spot near the cafe to practise how to push the victim off the cliff. The police say they have recovered three mobile phones (two belonging to Siya) and were currently analysing 355 GB of data. The two accused also allegedly tried to rope in Chetan's classmate who works in a private company at Balewadi in Pune, but he turned them down, says the police.

On June 18, Siya and Ketan trekked up to the fort, with Chetan

UNANSWERED QUESTIONS

↘ Absence of a strong motive: Siya could have put her foot down, refused to marry Ketan, even eloped with Chetan. Her brother Sahil had confronted the two of them. Family statements indicate Siya willingly accepted Ketan's proposal. So, why did she murder him?

↘ Who was the mastermind? While Siya is seen as the principal mastermind, the Pune rural police are trying to determine whether a third person was involved in the conspiracy. The role of more persons of interest is also being examined

↘ Lack of material evidence: There is no evidence to show Ketan was pushed. So far, no one has come forward as witness, nor has any incriminating evidence been discovered

↘ Digital footprint: The police claim months of WhatsApp chats and voice notes were found deleted in Siya and Chetan's phones. Will the recovery of the chats provide conclusive proof?

↘ Warning signs: Why did the Agarwals ignore red flags like Siya's references to Chetan, her phone being engaged whenever Ketan called her and, most importantly, Siya's alleged attempt to push Ketan off a ledge on June 14?

